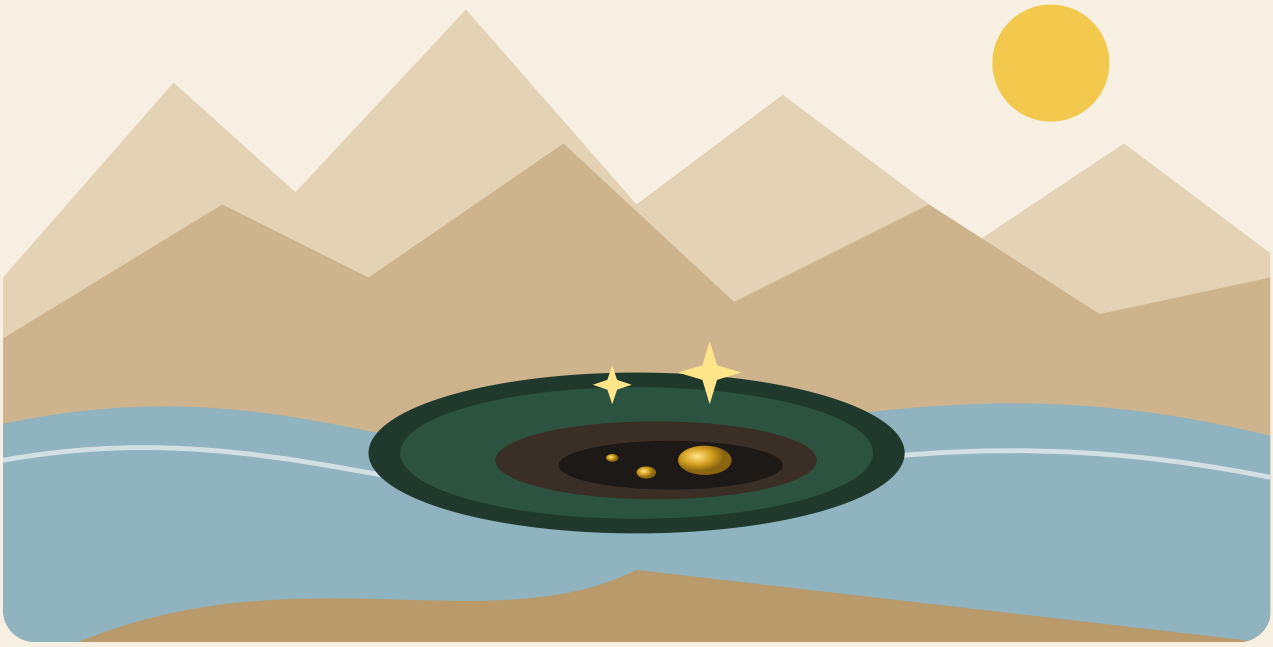
A FIRST FLAKE COMPANION FOR FAMILIES

Junior Prospector

Family Pack

Trip logs, games, badges and a real certificate for little gold hunters, ages 5 to 12





This pack belongs to: _____

Read the river. It already knows where the gold is.

READ THIS FIRST

A Note for Grown-Ups

This pack runs alongside the First Flake workbook, one kid page for every grown-up trip.

How it works

- **Do the workbook trips as usual.** Each trip has a matching kid page in here: a game, a hunt, or a job to do.
- **After every trip,** your junior prospector fills in a **Junior Trip Log** (page 12) and colors in a badge on the **Badge Tracker** (page 14).
- **Trip 7 ends with a certificate.** Page 16 has two: one for the day they find a flake, one for finishing all seven trips. Not every family finds gold on the first try, so every kid still goes home proud.

Which pages go with which trip

Trip	Kid page
Before you go	Safety Pledge (3) · How Gold Got Into the River (4) · My Prospector Kit (5)
Trip 1	The BB Rescue Challenge (6)
Trip 2	Creek Scavenger Hunt Bingo (7)
Trip 3	Bedrock Explorer (8)
Trip 4	Dirt Mover Tally (9)
Trip 5	Black Sand Detective (10) · Is It Gold? Junior Edition (11)
Trip 6	My Treasure Map (13)
Trip 7	Official Certificates (16)
Every trip	Junior Trip Log (12) · Badge Tracker (14) · Cut-Out Badges (15)

Printing tips

- Print the **Junior Trip Log** once per trip, and **My Treasure Map** as often as you like.
- Print **page 16** on card stock, then cut along the dashed line to get two certificates.
- Print **page 15** on full-sheet sticker paper, or on card stock and stick the badges on with tape.
- Younger kids (5 to 7): you read and write, they draw, color and count. Older kids (8 to 12) can run their own logs.

Josie and Grandpa Ezra are the workbook's fictional guides, written with help from AI. Everything they teach is real. For personal and household use: print what your family needs, but please don't resell or share the file. hello@firstflake.com

BEFORE YOUR FIRST TRIP

The Junior Prospector Safety Pledge

Real prospectors stay safe, so they can keep exploring.



- [ ] I always pan with a grown-up, and I stay where my grown-up can see me.



- [ ] I never go into the water alone. I stay in water below my knees.



- [ ] I wear a life jacket near deep or fast water.



- [ ] I don't climb on wet rocks or dig under creek banks.



- [ ] I wear a hat, drink water, and take breaks when my hands get cold.



- [ ] If I get lost, I stay put and blow my whistle three times.



- [ ] I fill my holes and take my trash home. The creek is for everyone.

I promise to follow these rules on every trip.

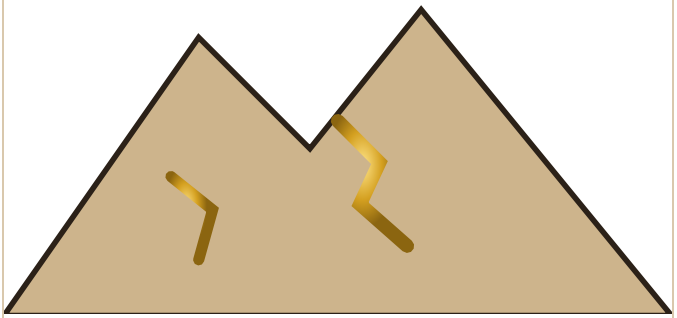
Junior prospector _____ **Grown-up** _____

Date _____

GROWN-UP NOTE This page is a conversation starter, not a substitute for supervision. Cold water and current are the real dangers, so keep small kids within arm's reach and in a life jacket near any moving water.

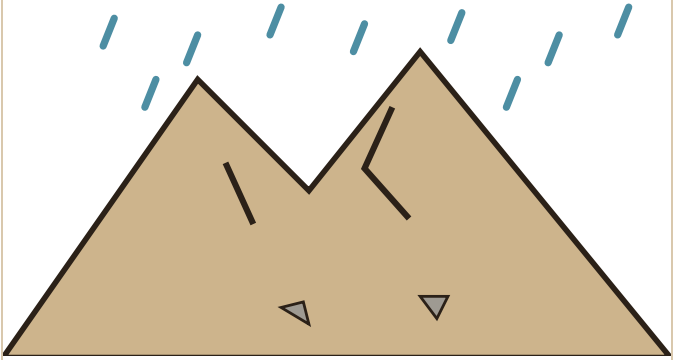
How Gold Got Into the River

1. Long, long ago



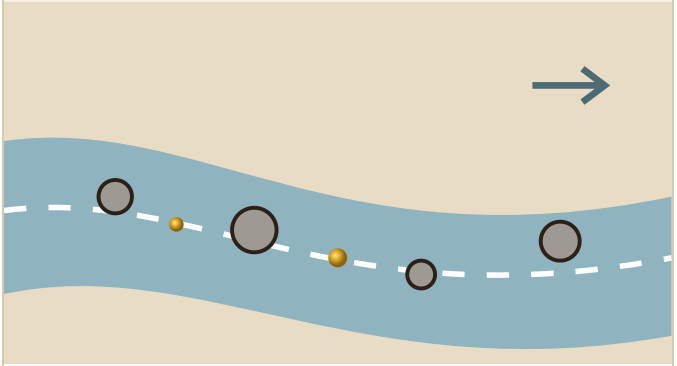
Gold was locked inside rocks, high up in the mountains.

2. Rain, ice and time



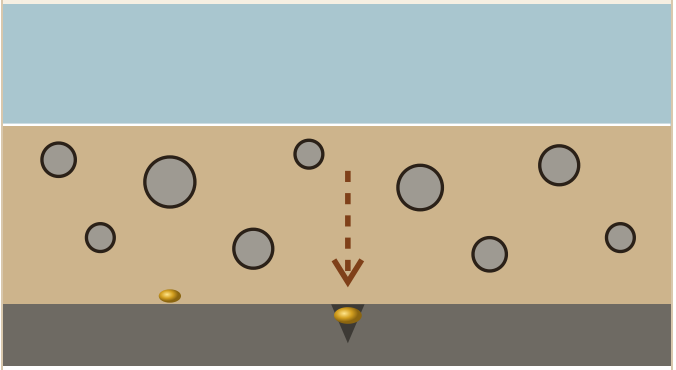
Rain, ice and roots cracked the rocks into smaller and smaller pieces.

3. Floods move everything



Big floods carried sand, rocks and tiny bits of gold down into the creek.

4. Gold is SO heavy



Gold is about 7 times heavier than sand, so it sinks to the bottom and gets stuck.

Heavy or light? Circle what happens in a tub of water.

Steel BB	SINKS	FLOATS	Dry leaf	SINKS	FLOATS
Gold flake	SINKS	FLOATS	Wine cork	SINKS	FLOATS
Pebble	SINKS	FLOATS	Twig	SINKS	FLOATS

Answers: Steel BB sinks · Dry leaf floats · Gold flake sinks · Wine cork floats · Pebble sinks · Twig floats

My Prospector Kit

Check off each thing as it goes in the bag.



☐ Gold pan



☐ Bucket



☐ Small scoop



☐ Snuffer bottle



☐ Gold vial



☐ Magnifying glass



☐ Magnet



☐ Hat



☐ Water bottle



☐ Snack



☐ Life jacket



☐ Dry socks



☐ Whistle

Draw one more thing you want to bring

Draw your very own gold pan

Give it a name, too!

Josie says

My first gold pan was named Biscuit. Don't ask me why. I was seven, and it seemed like a great name at the time.

The BB Rescue Challenge

Ten BBs are hiding in the gravel. Can you rescue all of them?

How to play

1. A grown-up mixes 10 steel BBs into a pan of gravel.
2. Shake the pan under the water, then tilt and wash, just like the workbook shows.
3. Count the BBs left in your pan, and color in that many circles.
4. Try to beat your own score every round!

Round	Color one circle for every BB you saved	Score	Stars
Round 1	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	/10	☆ ☆ ☆
Round 2	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	/10	☆ ☆ ☆
Round 3	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	/10	☆ ☆ ☆
Round 4	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	/10	☆ ☆ ☆
Round 5	○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○	/10	☆ ☆ ☆

Stars: 1 star for 6 or more, 2 stars for 8 or more, 3 stars for all 10!

My best score was _____ out of 10. My secret trick:

Grandpa Ezra says: *"I lost three BBs my first try in 1939. Pa made me find every one before supper."*

GROWN-UP NOTE Use steel BBs, not lead, and count them in and out so none end up on the floor.

☐ **I can rescue BBs. Color in my Tub Champ badge!**

TRIP 2 · READ THE RIVER

Creek Scavenger Hunt Bingo

Walk the creek with your grown-up before anyone digs. Mark every square you find.

An inside bend *Where the creek curves* ☐	**A gravel bar** *A beach of little rocks* ☐	**A giant boulder** *Bigger than you!* ☐	**Black sand** *Dark streaks in the sand* ☐
A crack in the rock *Gold hides in cracks* ☐	**A dragonfly** *Or any flying bug* ☐	**A heart-shaped rock** *Look closely!* ☐	**An animal track** *Bird, deer or raccoon* ☐
Moss *Soft and green* ☐	**A fish** *Watch the quiet water* ☐	**A rock with stripes** *Lines of color* ☐	**A waterfall** *Even a tiny one* ☐
A pine cone *Or any seed* ☐	**Something sparkly** *Gold? Mica? Check it!* ☐	**Quiet, slow water** *Gold likes lazy water* ☐	**Your choice!** *Draw it here* ☐

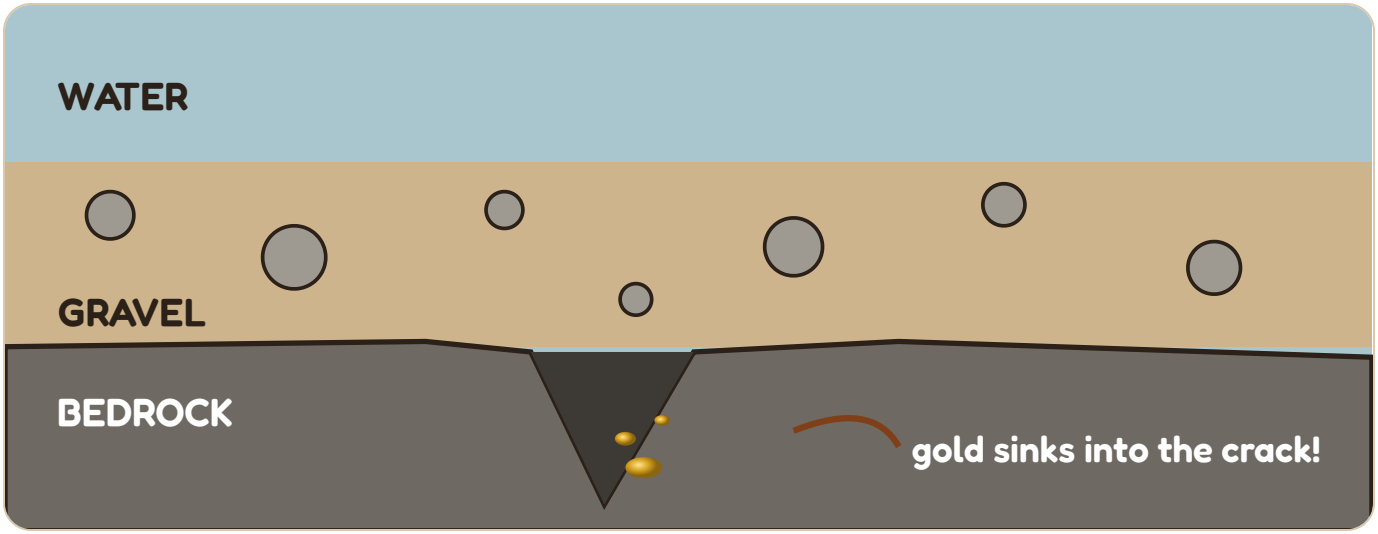
BINGO! Four in a row, across, down or corner to corner. **BLACKOUT!** Every single square.

> **Josie says**
> The first four squares are the best gold spots on any creek. If you found them, you just did what real prospectors do: look first, dig second.

☐ **I read the river. Color in my River Reader badge!**

Bedrock Explorer

Gold sinks until it can't. Then it hides in the cracks.



Find three cracks. Draw each one.

Crack 1

Did it have gold? YES NO

Crack 2

Did it have gold? YES NO

Crack 3

Did it have gold? YES NO

My guess: where would YOU hide if you were a flake of gold?

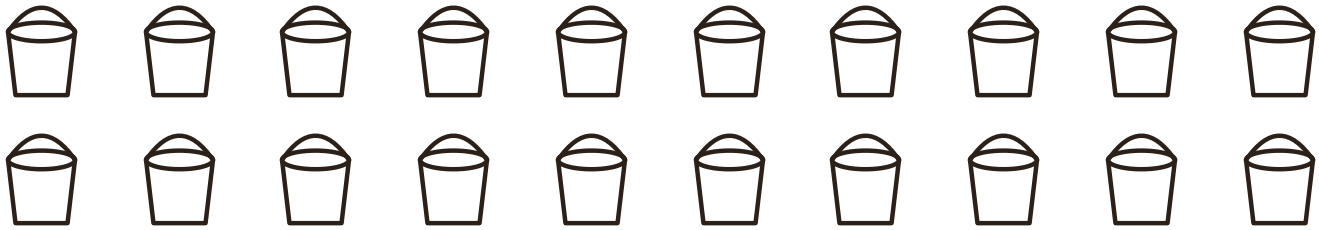
GROWN-UP NOTE Bedrock work means kneeling at the water's edge. Keep kids out of fast water and away from undercut banks while you clean cracks.

☐ **I explored the bedrock. Color in my Bedrock Explorer badge!**

Dirt Mover Tally

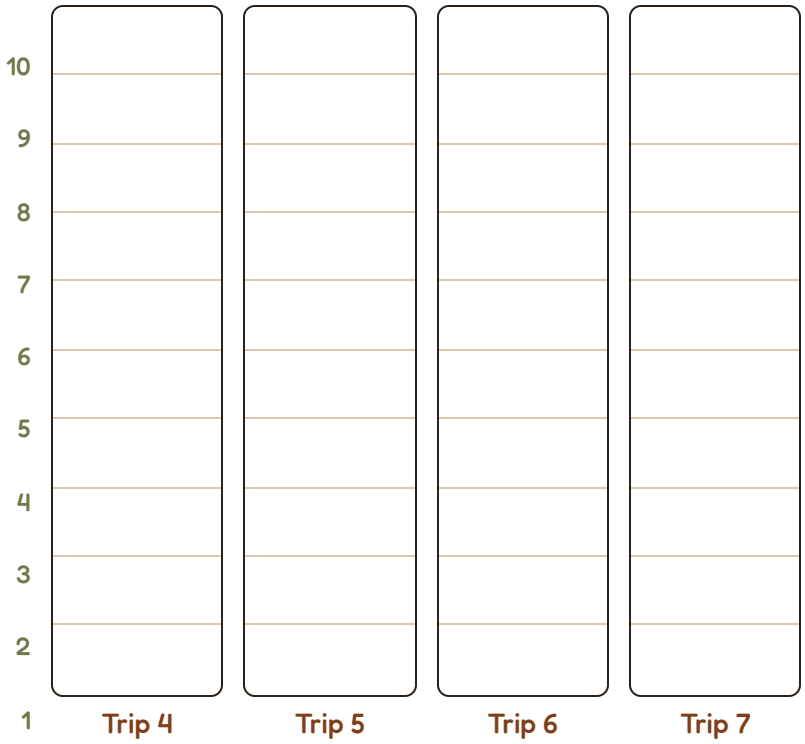
Move more dirt, not faster hands. Every bucket counts!

Color one bucket every time you fill one



My bucket chart

Color one box for each bucket, one column for each trip.

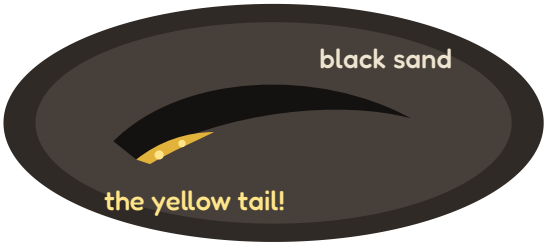


> **Grandpa Ezra says:** *"A strong back moves dirt. A smart prospector moves the right dirt."*

☐ **I moved a LOT of dirt. Color in my Dirt Mover badge!**

Black Sand Detective

Where there's black sand, gold isn't far.



Swirl the pan. The black sand slides away and the gold shows its yellow tail.

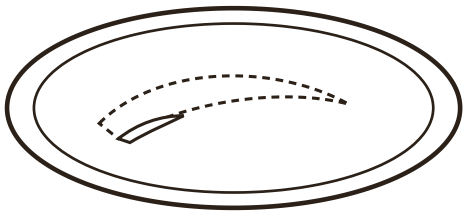
The magnet experiment

1. Put your magnet in a zip-top bag.
2. Wave it just above the dry black sand in your pan.
3. Watch the black sand jump up and stick!
4. Gold never sticks. Whatever stays behind is worth a closer look.

Did it stick to the magnet?

What I tested	Stuck?
Black sand	YES NO
A paper clip	YES NO
A coin	YES NO
	YES NO
	YES NO

Color the pan: black sand black, gold tail yellow



GROWN-UP NOTE Keep magnets away from kids who still put things in their mouths. Swallowed magnets are a medical emergency.

☐ **I'm a Black Sand Detective. Color in my badge!**

Is It Gold? Junior Edition

Lots of things sparkle. Only one of them is gold.



Gold

the real deal

- Bright yellow in sun AND shade
- Soft: bends or dents when poked
- Heavy: stays in the pan



Pyrite

"fool's gold"

- Brassy, flashes in the sun
- Hard and crumbly
- Often shaped like little cubes



Mica

the sparkly trickster

- Thin, shiny flakes
- Looks dull from the side
- Light: floats away easily

Who am I? Circle the answer.

1. It stays bright yellow, even in the shade.	Gold	Pyrite	Mica
2. It flashes in the sun and crumbles when you poke it.	Gold	Pyrite	Mica
3. It washes right out of the pan with the light sand.	Gold	Pyrite	Mica
4. It's shaped like tiny boxes.	Gold	Pyrite	Mica
5. It bends instead of breaking.	Gold	Pyrite	Mica
6. It goes dull and silvery when you turn it.	Gold	Pyrite	Mica

Answers: 1. Gold · 2. Pyrite · 3. Mica · 4. Pyrite · 5. Gold · 6. Mica

GROWN-UP NOTE The poke test uses a pin. Let a grown-up hold the pin, and never let kids bite or taste anything from the pan.

EVERY TRIP · PRINT ONE FOR EACH TRIP

My Junior Trip Log

Trip number

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

Date

_____

The creek I went to

_____

The weather was (circle it)



Sunny Cloudy Rainy Windy Chilly

Pans I washed

_____

Gold specks I saw

_____

Draw the best thing you found today

Gold, a cool rock, a frog, anything!

Today I felt (circle one)



Happy Amazed Okay Tired Cold

One thing I learned

_____

_____

Grown-up's initials

_____

Badge earned?

☐ **Yes! I colored it in.**

My Treasure Map

One pan is a guess. Ten pans are a map.

Draw the creek, then mark every pan you tried



Map key

- My best spot
- Big boulder
- Inside bend
- Where we parked
- Gravel bar
- Tree
- Pan with gold
- Empty pan

Name of my secret spot _____

Pans with gold _____ out of _____

☐ **I made a real prospector's map. Color in my Sample Scientist badge!**

EVERY TRIP

My Badge Tracker

Finish a trip, then color in its badge. Collect all seven!



Earned on _____



Earned on _____



Earned on _____



Earned on _____



Earned on _____



Earned on _____



The big one. Earned on _____

PRINT ON STICKER PAPER OR CARD STOCK

Cut-Out Badges

Earned a badge? Cut it out and stick it on your hat, your bucket or this pack.



Two spares at the bottom, for brothers, sisters and cousins. Grown-ups handle the scissors for little ones.

FIRST FLAKE · OFFICIAL

First Flake Finder

This certifies that

_____

found their very first flake of gold on _____
at _____ creek.

Tape a photo of your flake here

Read the river. It already knows where the gold is.

Josie	*Ezra*	
Josie McCall	Grandpa Ezra	Grown-up witness

cut here

FIRST FLAKE · OFFICIAL

Junior Prospector Graduate

This certifies that

_____

finished all seven trips of the First Flake adventure, learned to read a river, and earned the title of Junior Prospector on _____.



Real prospectors keep going. The gold has waited thousands of years. It will wait for you.

Josie	*Ezra*	
Josie McCall	Grandpa Ezra	Grown-up witness